

established domestic supply chain and cutting-edge infrastructure such as test facilities and launch pads. It also has the best cost efficiency for building space systems in the world. Also, India's new space policy is very robust and efficient, in addition to more venture capital flowing into the sector from last year," asserts Pawan Kumar Chandana, Co-founder and CEO of Skyroot Aerospace.

Consequently, three new industry bodies—the Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe), the ISpA, and NewSpace India Ltd. (NSIL)—have been created to realign space activities from a supply to demand-driven model. "The opening up of the space sector to private players and start-ups is a significant step towards augmenting the competitiveness of the Indian space programme by encouraging them to develop end-to-end space capabilities while also allowing Isro to focus on research and development of advanced space technologies, space exploration, and non-commercial missions," says Godrej Aerospace's Behramkamdin. Isro will, therefore, be focussing more on capacity building and the sharing of its facilities for commercial launches through NSIL and with non-government private entities through IN-SPACe.

"Earlier, private players collaborating with Isro or other government agencies were required to follow very stringent norms, such as keeping data secret or not sharing participation details. However, they are now allowed to talk about it, which has given confidence to smaller players," says Brajesh Singh, Associate Director at Arthur D. Little. This has been followed up with the rollout of enabling frameworks like

AN ENABLING FRAMEWORK

What needs to be done to help the nascent spacetechnology sector reach for the stars



A review of the Indian Space Policy, 2023, to stay abreast with global developments



Introduction of production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme and customs exemptions



Becoming a leader in building satellites and pushing internet adoption



Continued expansion of Isro's collaborations with more institutes and research labs



Building capabilities in space mining, manufacturing and in-orbit servicing



Tax reforms for supporting growth as well as making the end products globally competitive



A comprehensive study to fully tapping the sector's downstream capabilities



Early passage of the space law to keep local rules aligned with global frameworks

SOURCE: INDUSTRY, DELOITTE, ARTHUR D. LITTLE, BT RESEARCH

the Indian Space Policy, 2023, which delineates the roles of government organisations and provides clarity to private participants. Besides, the GST exemption on satellites put into space using locally made rockets launched from India and permitting up to 100 per cent FDI under the government route for firms involved

in satellite establishment and operations have been announced. "The emergence of firms like SpaceX and One Web has made the government understand that [this] sector cannot move ahead without private players," adds Singh.

Moreover, Chandrayaan-3's success and Aditya L1's progress have